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Section Title(S)

LINKED SIBS AND PRIVILEGED FAMILIARITY • SIB EXOGAMY AND CROSS-COUSIN MARRIAGE

As a matter of fact, it would seem that the chief pleasure in life for a Mangi is to have a laugh at the expense of an Mbunga or to 'pull something over on' an Mbunga,—the Wamangi and the Wabunga being, as we have mentioned, of sibs between which the joking relationship obtains. Such inter-sib *watani* may do or say whatsoever they like when there is question of their *watani*. If a Mangi passes through a village inhabited by Wabunga, the latter play all sorts of tricks on him. On the other hand, if a Mangi attends a beer-party given by the Wabunga, the Mangi is subject to no rules of etiquette. For example, he can walk into the house of an Mbunga without asking permission, and can drink all the beer he can lay his hands on and can eat any food he finds in the house. In the event of his getting drunk, he must be put up for the night in decent sleeping quarters. In the morning however it is the right of the Wabunga to insult him or laugh at him, and he has nothing to say. In such cases the parting words of an Mbunga are: "Go home and tell your friends that you failed in your attempt to bewitch us because your medicine was not strong enough for us". In general, any individual Mbunga may at any time or in any place attempt to make a fool of a Mangi, and vice versa.

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To my best knowledge, this right to banter or joke exists only between members of specific sibs between which the joking relationship exists. I have no knowledge of any such joking relationship between individuals or groups of related or unrelated individuals whose respective sibs are not linked by a joking relationship.

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It should also be added that intermarriage is interdicted between members of any two sibs between which there obtains the joking relationship, just as it is interdicted between members of the same sib.

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SIB EXOGAMY AND CROSS-COUSIN MARRIAGE

A person may, with the permission of his relatives or, if he dares, without that permission, marry any one he pleases, with the following exceptions. First, he is not permitted to marry any member of his own sib, that is, of the sib to which his mother  65 belongs. Secondly, he must not marry a "child" of a sib of which he himself is a "child", that is, a "child", in the sense explained by Father Wallis and myself, of his father's sib. Thirdly, he is prohibited from marrying a member of a sib with which his own sib has a joking relationship. Fourthly, he cannot marry a member of a sib which has a common origin with his own sib.

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